

Haorui Peng

Contact

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Education

- 2025– Ph.D., Sociology, University of Michigan
 - Advisor: Alexandra A. Killewald
- 2025 B.A., Sociology, University of Michigan
 with Highest Honors and Highest Distinction

Research Interests

Stratification & Mobility, Education, Social Demography, Quantitative Methods, China

Research Projects

- Peng, Haorui.** 2025. “Educational Trends, 1999 Higher Education Expansion, and Relative Intergenerational Occupation Persistence in Postsocialist China.” Honors Senior Thesis, Department of Sociology, University of Michigan.
- Winner of the Robert Cooley Angell Award (*best thesis, annual*), 2025.
 - Advisor: Alexandra A. Killewald

Honors and Awards

- 2025 Robert Cooley Angell Award, University of Michigan, for “Educational Trends, 1999 Higher Education Expansion, and Relative Intergenerational Occupation Persistence in Postsocialist China”
- Presented annually to the author of the best senior thesis in Sociology
- 2025 Nominee, Marshall Sahlins Social Science Award, University of Michigan
- 2025 James B. Angell Scholar, University of Michigan
- 2023-24 University Honors, University of Michigan
- 2021-22 Dean’s List, University of Wisconsin Oshkosh
- Fall 2021, Spring 2022, and Fall 2022 semesters

Scholarships and Grants

- 2025-26 Rackham Conference Travel Grant, Rackham Graduate School, University of Michigan (\$900)
- 2025-30 Lieberthal-Rogel Center for Chinese Studies Doctoral Fellowship, Lieberthal-Rogel Center for Chinese Studies, University of Michigan (\$25,000)
- 2022 Howard and Alice Curler Academic Excellence Scholarship, Community Foundation for the Fox Valley Region (\$1,750)

Conference Presentations

- Peng, Haorui.** “Educational Trends, 1999 Higher Education Expansion, and Relative Intergenerational Occupation Persistence in Postsocialist China.”
- 2026 Roundtable at the Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, New York City, New York, USA
 - 2026 Paper Presentation at the Annual Conference of the International Chinese Sociological Association, New York City, New York, USA
 - 2026 Oral Presentation at the Summer Meeting of the RC28 Social Stratification, International Sociological Association, New York City, New York, USA

- 2026 Poster Presentation at the Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, St. Louis, Missouri, USA
- 2025 Oral Presentation at the Annual Meeting of the Chinese Sociology Association, Chengdu, Sichuan, China.

Affiliations

RC28 Social Stratification, International Sociological Association

Population Association of America (PAA)

International Chinese Sociological Association (ICSA)

American Sociological Association (ASA)

Training & Non-Degree

- 2024 “[Specialization: Statistics with Python](#)” (including [Understanding and Visualizing Data with Python](#), [Inferential Statistical Analysis with Python](#), and [Fitting Statistical Models to Data with Python](#)) by University of Michigan. on Coursera.
- 2022 “[Specialization: Python for Everybody](#)” by University of Michigan. on Coursera.

Undergraduate Research Experiences

Intergenerational Education Mobility in Postsocialist China and Its Variation

Sociology 310 Class Project

2024.01 – 2024.05

- Analyzed data from CGSS 2017~2021 to explore the trend of intergenerational education mobility for people born 1969~2003 and its variation across gender, *hukou*, and geographic region.
- Estimated the “rank-rank correlations” between the percentile ranks of children’s and parents’ educational attainment to determine intergenerational mobility.
- Discovery: (1) educational mobility remained consistent across cohorts, except the youngest cohort (1999~2003); (2) gender has a slight overall impact on educational mobility; (3) urban *hukou* holders have lower educational mobility levels than their

rural counterparts; and (4) coastal regions in China exhibit lower levels of educational mobility compared to inland areas.

Exclusionary School Discipline and Student Races in the US: A Systematic Review

Research Assistant to Dr. Thomas Drake, School of Education

2023.09 – 2024.08

- Conducted a systematic search of relevant academic articles published between 2013 and 2024 on EBSCOhost with group-decided keywords; collect the datasets used in these articles.
- Co-led the processes of systematic review: decided to investigate African American students, Hispanic students, and Latino students compared to White students; clarified the definition of exclusionary discipline; led the analysis programming using R.
- Assisted with organizing regular group meetings, monitoring paper collections, and managing group documents.

Field Observation: Social Workers in Urban Villages in Shenzhen, China

Leader of Summer Research Project

2023.07

- Interviewed 10 social workers in Dahe Village, Shenzhen, who are community hired and who work in NGOs; conducted observations on the processes of their services; collected notes of 8,000+ words.
- Summarized the characteristics of these social workers, the process of their services, their achievements; analyzed the features and strengths of social work in Shenzhen, and the reasons of its high quality.
- Composed a report on these discoveries and provided suggestions on quality improvements in Nanjing.

Literature Review: “Double Reduction” Policy in China as Part of Its Education Reform

Summer Research Project

2022.05 – 2022.11

- Reviewed prior research on “The Guidelines to Further Ease the Burden of Excessive Homework and Off-campus Tutoring for Students undergoing Compulsory Education (Double Reduction)”; read prior studies relevant to distributive justice, relative deprivation, and social mobility.
- Collected academic comments on Double Reduction policies on the aftermath, including changes in the amount of homework, students’ involvement in shadow-education sessions, students’ examination performances, teachers’ feedback, etc.
- Summarized possible positive outcomes and potential negative impacts on educational fairness; provided suggestions on future reforms.

Additional Information

Languages Mandarin (native), English (proficient), French (basic), German (basic)

Coding	R, Stata, Excel, Python, LaTeX
IT Skills	Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, Audition; Final Cut Pro